

Brian Shimkus

SOLUTIONS ENGINEER · AI INTEGRATION

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SUMMARY

Pre-sales Solutions Engineer specializing in AI integration. I run the full technical sales motion at Insolla, an independent AI consulting practice: discovery calls, solution scoping, tailored demos, and proof-of-concept builds that win engagements, including a source-grounded RAG assistant over live Salesforce CRM data. Enterprise background delivering customer-facing solutions inside regulated financial organizations (OCC, TransUnion, Marex): weekly stakeholder discovery and demo sessions, cross-functional delivery, and enterprise API integration.

SOLUTIONS DELIVERY SKILLS

Pre-Sales	Technical Discovery · Tailored Demos · POC Scoping & Delivery · Solution Design · Objection Handling · Executive Presentations · Client Enablement
AI & LLM	OpenAI APIs · LangChain · Pinecone · RAG Architecture · Embeddings · Structured Outputs · Source Grounding · Prompt Design · Python
Integration	REST APIs · FastAPI · Salesforce API (OAuth 2.0 JWT) · Node.js · SQL (MySQL) · DocuSign API · AWS
Automation	Make.com · n8n · Airtable · Hunter.io · Brevo
Front-End	React · Next.js · TypeScript · JavaScript · Redux · Tailwind · Jest · Playwright

EXPERIENCE

Insolla | AI Solutions Engineer (Independent Consulting Practice)

Dec 2025 – Present

Applied AI tools for CRM intelligence, process analysis, SOP generation, and operational automation, sold and delivered end to end.

- Own the complete pre-sales motion as sole technical seller: run discovery calls to surface business pain, scope solutions, deliver tailored demos, and build proofs-of-concept that convert prospects into engagements.
- Present technical recommendations to non-technical decision makers; handle objections on hallucination risk, data security, and build-vs-buy in every sales conversation.
- **Flagship demo asset:** built and deployed a RAG assistant enabling natural-language queries over live Salesforce CRM records with grounded, source-cited answers (Python, LangChain, Pinecone, OpenAI, Streamlit); secured via OAuth 2.0 JWT server-to-server authentication. Live demo at [RAG.Insolla.ai](https://rag.insolla.ai).
- **Five additional shipped tools:** AdvisorFlow AI (source-grounded meeting-prep briefs from CRM data; FastAPI/Next.js), Workflow Analyzer (SOPs and process docs to workflow maps and automation recommendations), SOP Generator, List Enricher, and Meeting Notes Analyzer.
- Every tool ships with source grounding, structured outputs, and human-review paths, the difference between an impressive demo and an adopted solution.

TerraFort (Freelance) | Lead Front-End Developer*Aug 2025 – Dec 2025*

- Led design and development of a web and mobile platform at an early-stage startup, executing product initiatives from concept to delivery.
- Owned vendor-facing technical evaluations, integrating third-party and AI tooling into the product; led collaboration across UX, product, and backend teams.

OCC (Contract) | Senior Front-End Developer*Jul 2024 – Jun 2025*

- Ran weekly stakeholder sessions at a systemically important financial market utility: goal setting, live progress demos, and open-question resolution.
- Independently delivered React/TypeScript solutions from Figma through production across test, QA, and prod; implemented Mock Service Worker to unblock front-end work from backend dependencies.

Marex | Lead Front-End Developer*Oct 2020 – Jan 2024*

- Led the program that digitalized previously manual broker and trader onboarding at a global financial services firm, taking a compliance-heavy, paper-based workflow fully digital end to end and winning adoption from the teams whose daily work changed.
- Led a five-person front-end team delivering stakeholder-driven solutions in an agile environment; designed and ran the team's internship program.
- Integrated the DocuSign API to digitize document signing across all products.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Walker & Dunlop (Contract) | Senior Front-End Developer*Mar – Oct 2020*

Built Vue.js platform components with Storybook; connected front-end to APIs.

ICF | Senior Front-End Developer*Jan 2019 – Mar 2020*

Led front-end lifecycle; standardized web accessibility across projects.

TransUnion | Front-End Developer*Jan 2018 – Jan 2019*

Built a Contentful-based CMS for content owners; deployed to AWS.

R1 RCM | UX Architect / Front-End Developer*Apr 2016 – Jan 2018*

Partnered with directors to identify product gaps; built working AngularJS prototypes.

TimeZoneOne (Contract) | Front-End Developer*Aug 2015 – Apr 2016*

Custom WordPress themes and cross-browser development; clients included Athletico and the Chicago Wolves.

Kohactive | Junior Front-End Developer*Aug 2013 – Aug 2015*

Built responsive client sites (Ruby on Rails, SASS); led client meetings with Aon, Manchester United, and The Vitality Group.

EDUCATION

Art Institute of Chicago | BFA, Graphic Design (2013) · 3.9 GPA, Dean's List

Western Illinois University | Instructional Design & Technology (2008–2010)